INDIA AND HER NEIGHBOURS

India and Pakistan

Two Countries, India and Pakistan were born out of the partition of British India, in 1947. The two, since their births, have been archrivals. Their relationship has seen many ups and downs. The major irritants in their relation have been disputes pertaining to borders, distribution/sharing of river waters, territorial disputes, Afghanistan, cross-border terrorism and above all Kashmir. Liberation of Bangladesh in 1971 and India's role in it still disturbs the Pakistani minds.

The two countries have problem over the Siachen Glacier. India's position is that Pakistan should accept the **actual ground position line** (AGPL) on Siachen where its troops have been in position since 1984. Pakistan demands that India should pull back to the position occupied in 1972. The Siachen figures as one of the eight issues of the composite dialogue process. Regarding Sir Creek** both sides are forwarding their claims and undefined boundary is complicating the issue. Fishermen are often caught and jailed. The Wullar Barrage-Tulbul Project dating back to 1985 also invited the Pakistani ire. Pakistan saw it as a violation of the Indus Water Treaty (IWT), 1960. After rounds of failed negotiations in the recent years both sides have agreed to work out an early and amicable solution on the basis of technical consultations and the provisions of the IWT, 1960. The Baglihar Hydropower project was started by India in 1999. This has also been objected to by Pakistan on similar grounds. Pakistan alleges India of violating the IWT, 1960. In January 2005, Secretary-level talks were held, but without much result. Ultimately the matter was referred to the World Bank which appointed Prof. Raymond Lafitte as the Neutral Expert (NE) to study the project and consider Pakistan's objections to the project. The Kishenganga Hydropower project being built by India on the Jhelum River has been objected to by Pakistan. Similar arguments and allegations of violation of IWT, 1960 have been raised. There is also apprehension on the part of Pakistan regarding manipulation of water flow of river by India. Pakistan has also objected to the construction of the Nimoo Bazgo